



CIS 5640: Introduction to Game Design

Assignment 1: MDA Analysis

Let's practice analyzing the relationship between game mechanics and the player experience they create. Using the [Mechanics, Dynamics, Aesthetics framework](#), analyze a game of your choosing. Try to aim for a total length of **2 pages**!

1. Choose a game to analyze. The game can be digital or analog or physical, but should be reasonably complex.
2. Write a *short* description of the game. You should describe
 - The high level player experience. If you were the game director, how would you describe the vision of this game?
 - The objective of the game
 - The narrative premise of the game
 - The procedure of the game. In brief, what is the player doing?
3. Choose three mechanics from this game. For each mechanic, provide a breakdown of
 - **THE MECHANICS**: what is the game "rule"?
 - This should be what literally is the code or rulebook enforcing?
 - For example "The force of gravity applies to all characters" or "Performing a headshot gives the player a 10 point bonus"
 - **THE DYNAMICS**: what player behavior does this elicit?
 - Dynamics are the player's response within the game environment. NOT what the system does, but how the player behaves as a result of the rules of the game.
 - For example, because diamonds have a low rarity, players will be more likely to be selective in when they use them, as opposed to a different resource.
 - For example, in games with a kill streak bonus, players are more likely to try to continue being aggressive after getting a single kill.
 - **THE AESTHETICS**: what emotional response does this evoke?
 - This is what YOU feel as you're playing the game when the Mechanics and Dynamics happen. You should be using **emotion** words when describing aesthetics.

- For example, in Minecraft, when you fall from a high place and don't have a bucket of water to break your fall, you may feel frustrated that your character will die or get a lot of damage. You may feel anxious navigating high-up terrain.
4. Write a brief reflection on how the three mechanics you've chosen work together to support the vision of the game. Or don't!